

BUSINESS ENGLISH CORE CURRICULUM FOR HR PROFESSIONALS

A 30-Session B1–B2 Corporate Curriculum and Instructional Guide

Designed by Rayene Medabis

TESOL-Certified Instructional Designer & EFL Educator

M.Ed. in Didactics

Teacher Trainer & Curriculum Designer | Follow Me Academy

Course Level: B1–B2 (CEFR) | Duration: 30 Sessions / 45 Instructional Hours

June 2026

© 2026 Rayene Medabis. All Rights Reserved.

This curriculum and its accompanying instructional materials are the original work of Rayene Medabis and may not be reproduced, distributed, or repurposed without permission.

Part I — Curriculum Overview

Course Description

This curriculum is a 30-session core program in Business English, designed for corporate employees working in Human Resources at CEFR B1 (low-intermediate) to B2 (upper-intermediate) levels. It is built specifically around the communication tasks HR professionals encounter day to day: recruitment, onboarding, performance management, internal communication, meetings, and cross-cultural collaboration. The course progresses through six thematic modules of five sessions each, moving learners from foundational workplace communication toward complex, nuanced business interaction.

Target Audience & Entry Level

HR professionals — including HR business partners, recruiters, learning and development officers, and HR generalists — working in English-medium or partially English-medium environments, requiring English for internal and external HR communication. The course is designed for mixed-level cohorts spanning CEFR B1 to B2; differentiation strategies (B1 scaffold / B2 extension) are built into every session.

Course Duration & Format

30 sessions of 90 minutes each (45 instructional hours), recommended at a pace of two sessions per week over approximately 15 weeks, though the curriculum can be adapted to intensive or extended delivery schedules. Suggested group size is 6 to 12 corporate learners, delivered in-person or via live virtual classroom.

Pedagogical Framework

The curriculum uses a task-based, communicative approach: learners encounter target language in context, practice it under guidance, and then apply it to realistic HR and corporate tasks. Every session follows a consistent five-stage lesson cycle — Warm-up, Input, Guided Practice, Production, and Wrap-up & Assessment — so that teachers can deliver the program predictably while learners build familiarity with the rhythm of each class. Differentiation between B1 and B2 learners is embedded throughout, typically through scaffolded language frames for B1 learners and open, extended-production tasks for B2 learners.

Course Goals

Goals describe the broad, aspirational purpose of the course.

- Equip HR professionals to communicate confidently and professionally in English across spoken and written workplace contexts.
- Develop the language competencies needed for core HR functions: recruitment, onboarding, performance management, and policy communication.
- Build proficiency in core business communication genres, including emails, reports, meetings, presentations, and negotiations.
- Strengthen intercultural and interpersonal communication skills for diverse, multinational workplace environments.

- Progress learners along the CEFR continuum, consolidating B1 competencies while extending learners toward B2 fluency, accuracy, and complexity.

Course-Level Objectives

Objectives describe what the course is designed to teach — the specific instructional intentions that guide session design across all six modules.

- Apply appropriate register and tone across spoken and written business communication.
- Produce clear, well-structured professional emails, memos, and reports.
- Participate effectively in meetings, including leading discussions and recording minutes.
- Use HR-specific language accurately in recruitment, onboarding, feedback, and grievance-handling contexts.
- Deliver structured, audience-aware presentations using appropriate signposting and data description.
- Negotiate, persuade, and resolve workplace conflict using diplomatic, culturally sensitive language.

Course-Level Outcomes (CLOs)

Outcomes describe what learners will be able to demonstrate by the end of the course, expressed as CEFR-aligned can-do statements.

- Can communicate confidently in routine professional interactions (B1) and in increasingly complex, nuanced exchanges (B2).
- Can write coherent, appropriately structured business correspondence and HR documentation.
- Can actively contribute to, and where required lead, meetings and group discussions in English.
- Can perform core HR communication tasks — interviewing, feedback, policy explanation — accurately and professionally.
- Can deliver a clear, organized presentation and respond to questions from colleagues or stakeholders.
- Can negotiate solutions and manage workplace conflict using appropriate diplomatic language.

Curriculum Structure: Module Overview

The 30 sessions are organized into six five-session modules, sequenced to build from foundational communication toward complex, HR-specific, and integrative tasks.

Module	Focus	Sessions
Module 1	Establishes the spoken-language foundations learners will build on throughout the course: introducing themselves, making small talk, handling calls, asking for information, and describing their role within the organization.	1–5

Module	Focus	Sessions
Module 2	Develops the core written genres of corporate life — emails, polite requests, reports, memos, and HR policy documents — with a focus on register, structure, and clarity.	6–10
Module 3	Builds the spoken and written language needed to schedule, participate in, lead, and document meetings, and to collaborate on group problem-solving.	11–15
Module 4	Targets the specialized communication tasks central to HR practice: recruitment writing, interviewing, onboarding, performance feedback, and sensitive conversations.	16–20
Module 5	Develops the skills needed to plan, structure, and deliver a professional presentation, including describing data, handling questions, and delivering short training sessions.	21–25
Module 6	Consolidates the course through negotiation, persuasive communication, conflict mediation, cross-cultural awareness, and an integrated final assessment scenario.	26–30

Module titles in full:

- Module 1: Foundations of Professional Communication
- Module 2: Written Business Communication
- Module 3: Meetings & Collaboration
- Module 4: HR-Specific Communication
- Module 5: Presentations & Public Speaking
- Module 6: Negotiation, Persuasion & Intercultural Competence

Part II — 30-Session Curriculum Map

The table below provides a scope-and-sequence overview of all 30 sessions: topic, CEFR level focus, core language focus, and skills emphasis. Full lesson objectives, outcomes, and teaching procedures for each session are provided in Part III, the Instructional Guide.

Module 1: Foundations of Professional Communication

Establishes the spoken-language foundations learners will build on throughout the course: introducing themselves, making small talk, handling calls, asking for information, and describing their role within the organization.

#	Session Title	Level Focus	Language Focus	Skills
1	Course Orientation & Professional Self-Introduction	B1 (B2 extension)	Present simple vs. present continuous; job-role, department, and company-structure vocabulary; self-introduction formulas.	Speaking, Listening
2	Workplace Small Talk & Building Rapport	B1 (B2 extension)	Question tags, social expressions, and topics appropriate or inappropriate for workplace small talk.	Speaking, Listening
3	Telephone & Video Call Etiquette	B1 (B2 extension)	Telephone functional language (clarifying, spelling, holding); video-call vocabulary and etiquette.	Listening, Speaking
4	Asking For and Giving Information (Direct & Indirect Questions)	B1–B2	Direct vs. indirect question structures; polite request language.	Speaking, Writing
5	Describing Roles, Responsibilities & Company Structure	B1–B2	Organizational vocabulary — hierarchy, departments, reporting lines; relative clauses for describing roles.	Speaking, Writing

Module 2: Written Business Communication

Develops the core written genres of corporate life — emails, polite requests, reports, memos, and HR policy documents — with a focus on register, structure, and clarity.

#	Session Title	Level Focus	Language Focus	Skills
6	Email Writing Fundamentals: Tone, Register & Structure	B1 (B2 extension)	Email structure — subject, greeting, body, sign-off; formal vs. informal register.	Writing, Reading
7	Requests, Reminders & Polite Follow-Ups	B1–B2	Modal verbs for politeness — could, would, might; softening and hedging language.	Writing, Speaking
8	Reporting & Summarizing Information in Writing	B1–B2	Report structure — introduction, findings, recommendations; summarizing and paraphrasing language.	Writing, Reading
9	Internal Memos, Announcements & Notices	B1–B2	Concise, impersonal style; passive voice for announcements; bullet-point formatting conventions.	Writing
10	Writing Clear HR Policies & Procedures	B2 (B1 supported)	Sequencing language; imperative and passive forms for instructions; clarity and conciseness strategies.	Writing, Reading

Module 3: Meetings & Collaboration

Builds the spoken and written language needed to schedule, participate in, lead, and document meetings, and to collaborate on group problem-solving.

#	Session Title	Level Focus	Language Focus	Skills
11	Scheduling Meetings & Setting Agendas	B1–B2	Language for proposing and confirming times; agenda structure and vocabulary.	Writing, Speaking
12	Participating in Meetings: Opinions, Agreement & Disagreement	B1–B2	Functional language for opinions, agreeing, disagreeing, and interrupting politely.	Speaking, Listening
13	Leading a Meeting: Facilitation Language	B2 (B1 supported)	Facilitation phrases for opening, redirecting, summarizing, and closing a meeting.	Speaking
14	Taking & Writing Minutes	B1–B2	Reported speech for minutes; minutes structure and conventions — action points, decisions.	Writing, Listening
15	Collaborative Problem-Solving & Brainstorming	B1–B2	Brainstorming and idea-generation language; language for building on others' ideas; consensus-building phrases.	Speaking, Listening

Module 4: HR-Specific Communication

Targets the specialized communication tasks central to HR practice: recruitment writing, interviewing, onboarding, performance feedback, and sensitive conversations.

#	Session Title	Level Focus	Language Focus	Skills
16	Recruitment Language: Job Descriptions & Job Ads	B1–B2	Job-ad vocabulary and conventions; modal verbs for requirements — must, should, would be an advantage.	Writing, Reading
17	Conducting Interviews: Questioning Techniques	B2 (B1 supported)	Open vs. closed questions; behavioral/competency-based question structures, e.g. “Tell me about a time when...”.	Speaking, Listening
18	Onboarding New Employees: Explaining Procedures	B1–B2	Explaining and instructing language; sequencing connectors — first, next, once you’ve, make sure to.	Speaking, Listening
19	Giving Constructive Performance Feedback	B2 (B1 supported)	Feedback language — positive framing, “I” statements, Situation–Behavior–Impact structure; softening criticism.	Speaking, Listening
20	Handling Employee Grievances & Sensitive Conversations	B2 (B1 supported)	Empathetic and neutral language; de-escalation phrases; confidentiality and procedural language.	Speaking, Listening

Module 5: Presentations & Public Speaking

Develops the skills needed to plan, structure, and deliver a professional presentation, including describing data, handling questions, and delivering short training sessions.

#	Session Title	Level Focus	Language Focus	Skills
21	Structuring a Business Presentation	B2 (B1 supported)	Presentation structure — introduction, body, conclusion; purpose and audience-analysis vocabulary.	Speaking, Writing
22	Presentation Language: Signposting & Transitions	B2 (B1 supported)	Signposting phrases — firstly, moving on to, to summarize; transition language between sections.	Speaking
23	Describing Data: Charts, Graphs & Trends	B2 (B1 supported)	Trend vocabulary — rise, fall, fluctuate, plateau; prepositions and adverbs for describing change.	Speaking, Writing
24	Handling Q&A & Engaging an Audience	B2 (B1 supported)	Language for inviting, clarifying, and responding to questions; buying-time phrases.	Speaking, Listening
25	Delivering Training Sessions (Instructional Language)	B2 (B1 supported)	Instructional language for training delivery; checking understanding and managing group activities aloud.	Speaking

Module 6: Negotiation, Persuasion & Intercultural Competence

Consolidates the course through negotiation, persuasive communication, conflict mediation, cross-cultural awareness, and an integrated final assessment scenario.

#	Session Title	Level Focus	Language Focus	Skills
26	Negotiation Basics: Language of Compromise	B2	Conditional sentences for negotiation; language of offering, countering, and compromising.	Speaking
27	Persuasive Language & Making a Business Case	B2	Persuasive language — benefits-focused phrasing, rhetorical questions, evidence framing; structuring an argument.	Speaking, Writing
28	Conflict Resolution & Mediation Language	B2	Mediation and neutral-reframing language; language for finding common ground.	Speaking, Listening
29	Cross-Cultural Communication in the Workplace	B1–B2	Hedging and diplomatic language; vocabulary for discussing cultural difference respectfully; clarifying-meaning strategies.	Speaking, Listening
30	Course Review, Mock Scenarios & Final Assessment	B1–B2 (integrated review)	Integrated review of course language across all modules; self-evaluation language.	Speaking, Listening, Writing, Reading (integrated)

Part III — Instructional Guide: How to Teach Each Lesson

This guide provides a complete lesson plan for each of the 30 sessions, intended for use by the teacher delivering the course. Each lesson plan includes its objectives, outcomes, required materials, a step-by-step teaching procedure built on the course's consistent five-stage lesson cycle, and a teacher tip for differentiating between B1 and B2 learners within the same session.

Module 1: Foundations of Professional Communication

Establishes the spoken-language foundations learners will build on throughout the course: introducing themselves, making small talk, handling calls, asking for information, and describing their role within the organization.

Session 1: Course Orientation & Professional Self-Introduction

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1 (B2 extension)	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 1

Language Focus: Present simple vs. present continuous; job-role, department, and company-structure vocabulary; self-introduction formulas.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify personal and course-level learning goals through a structured needs analysis.
- Apply present simple and present continuous accurately to describe current responsibilities and projects.
- Deliver a clear, professional self-introduction appropriate to a workplace setting.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can give a structured one- to two-minute professional self-introduction.
- Can describe day-to-day responsibilities using the correct tense.
- Can ask and answer basic questions about colleagues' roles and departments.

Materials

Needs-analysis questionnaire • Role/department vocabulary cards • Model self-introduction script • Name cards

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Mingle activity — employees ask three colleagues “What do you do?” using a model question.
Input	20 min	Teacher presents/reviews present simple vs. continuous for routines vs. current projects, and key department/role vocabulary.
Guided Practice	25 min	Gap-fill and sentence-transformation exercises; matching departments to functions.
Production	25 min	Each employee prepares and delivers a one- to two-minute self-introduction; peers note one follow-up question.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Needs-analysis discussion; teacher records individual goals and baseline level.

Teacher Tip: Give B1 learners a sentence frame for the introduction; ask B2 learners to add one unscripted detail about a recent project.

Session 2: Workplace Small Talk & Building Rapport

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1 (B2 extension)	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 1

Language Focus: Question tags, social expressions, and topics appropriate or inappropriate for workplace small talk.

Lesson Objectives

- Recognize culturally appropriate small-talk topics in a multinational workplace.
- Use question tags and follow-up questions to sustain short conversations.
- Initiate and close small talk naturally in professional situations.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can initiate and maintain brief workplace small talk for two to three exchanges.
- Can use question tags and active-listening responses correctly.
- Can identify topics to avoid in a professional, multicultural setting.

Materials

Small-talk topic cards (safe/risky) • Audio dialogues • Conversation-starter prompts

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Brainstorm “good” vs. “risky” small-talk topics in pairs.
Input	20 min	Present small-talk functional language, question tags, and active-listening phrases via a model dialogue.
Guided Practice	25 min	Listen to sample dialogues and identify functional language; controlled pair practice with prompt cards.
Production	25 min	Rotating “networking event” role-play — employees move between partners making small talk.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer feedback on naturalness; teacher elicits one new phrase each learner will use this week.

Teacher Tip: Pair B1 learners with B2 partners during production to model extended responses.

Session 3: Telephone & Video Call Etiquette

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1 (B2 extension)	90 minutes	Listening, Speaking	Module 1

Language Focus: Telephone functional language (clarifying, spelling, holding); video-call vocabulary and etiquette.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the functional phrases used to open, manage, and close a phone or video call.
- Apply clarification and repetition strategies when communication breaks down.
- Demonstrate professional video-call etiquette in a simulated call.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can open, hold, and close a professional phone/video call appropriately.
- Can ask for clarification or repetition politely.
- Can spell names and confirm details accurately over the phone.

Materials

Audio call recordings • Phonetic alphabet handout • Video-call role-play cards • Paired devices or desks for simulated calls

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Listen to a short call recording and identify the stages: greeting, purpose, closing.
Input	20 min	Present call-management phrases, the phonetic alphabet, and video-call etiquette norms.
Guided Practice	25 min	Listening-for-gist/detail exercise; spelling-practice drills using the phonetic alphabet.
Production	25 min	Paired call simulations — one information-gap call, one scheduling call — using prompt cards.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Self-assessment checklist on call etiquette; teacher highlights common errors.

Teacher Tip: For B1 learners, provide a phrase bank; for B2 learners, add an unexpected complication, such as a bad connection or wrong department, to manage.

Session 4: Asking For and Giving Information (Direct & Indirect Questions)

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Speaking, Writing	Module 1

Language Focus: Direct vs. indirect question structures; polite request language.

Lesson Objectives

- Differentiate between direct and indirect question structures.
- Apply indirect questions to request information politely.
- Produce accurate questions to gather workplace information from a colleague.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can form indirect questions accurately, e.g. “Could you tell me...”, “I was wondering...”.
- Can request and provide information politely in spoken and written exchanges.
- Can adapt question forms depending on formality level.

Materials

Direct/indirect question transformation worksheet • Information-gap role cards • Formality-scale handout

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Compare a blunt direct question with a polite indirect version; discuss tone differences.
Input	20 min	Present the grammar of indirect questions and politeness strategies.
Guided Practice	25 min	Transformation drills, direct to indirect; error-correction exercise.
Production	25 min	Information-gap activity — employees use indirect questions to complete a colleague’s “profile.”
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Quick-write: three indirect questions for a real workplace situation; peer check.

Teacher Tip: B2 learners should be pushed to vary their opening phrases beyond “Could you tell me...”; B1 learners can rely on a fixed set of frames.

Session 5: Describing Roles, Responsibilities & Company Structure

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Speaking, Writing	Module 1

Language Focus: Organizational vocabulary — hierarchy, departments, reporting lines; relative clauses for describing roles.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify key vocabulary for organizational structure and reporting lines.
- Apply relative clauses to describe roles and responsibilities precisely.
- Produce a short spoken or written description of a team's structure.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can describe an organization's structure and reporting lines clearly.
- Can use relative clauses to add detail to role descriptions.
- Can read and interpret a simple organizational chart.

Materials

Sample organizational charts • Relative-clause worksheet • Blank org-chart template

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Look at a sample org chart and identify reporting lines.
Input	20 min	Present organizational vocabulary and relative clauses — who, which, that — for describing roles.
Guided Practice	25 min	Sentence-combining exercise using relative clauses; vocabulary matching.
Production	25 min	In groups, employees draft and present their own department's org chart using the target language.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Gallery walk of org charts with peer questions; oral mini-review of Module 1.

Teacher Tip: Use learners' real organizational structure where possible to maximize relevance and engagement.

Module 2: Written Business Communication

Develops the core written genres of corporate life — emails, polite requests, reports, memos, and HR policy documents — with a focus on register, structure, and clarity.

Session 6: Email Writing Fundamentals: Tone, Register & Structure

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1 (B2 extension)	90 minutes	Writing, Reading	Module 2

Language Focus: Email structure — subject, greeting, body, sign-off; formal vs. informal register.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the structural components of a professional email.
- Distinguish formal from informal register in written communication.
- Produce a well-structured, appropriately toned business email.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can write a clearly structured email with an appropriate greeting and sign-off.
- Can select register appropriate to the relationship and purpose.
- Can identify and correct register errors in a sample email.

Materials

Sample emails, formal and informal • Register-matching worksheet • Email-writing template

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Compare two emails on the same topic, one formal and one too casual; discuss the differences.
Input	20 min	Present email structure and register markers — openings, closings, hedging language.
Guided Practice	25 min	Register-correction exercise; reorder a scrambled email into the correct structure.
Production	25 min	Employees write an original email for a given workplace scenario, such as requesting leave approval.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer review using a structure/register checklist; teacher collects for written feedback.

Teacher Tip: Provide B1 learners with sentence starters for each section; ask B2 learners to write two versions, formal and semi-formal, for comparison.

Session 7: Requests, Reminders & Polite Follow-Ups

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Writing, Speaking	Module 2

Language Focus: Modal verbs for politeness — could, would, might; softening and hedging language.

Lesson Objectives

- Apply modal verbs to make polite requests and reminders.
- Use softening language to follow up without sounding demanding.
- Produce a polite reminder email for an overdue task.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can make a polite request using appropriate modal verbs.
- Can write a follow-up email that maintains a positive professional tone.
- Can recognize overly direct or impolite phrasing and revise it.

Materials

Modal-verb reference sheet • Sample reminder emails, effective and ineffective • Scenario cards

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Rank three reminder emails from most to least polite; discuss why.
Input	20 min	Present modal verbs and hedging phrases for requests and follow-ups.
Guided Practice	25 min	Sentence-rewriting drill, direct command to polite request; gap-fill with modals.
Production	25 min	Employees write a follow-up email for an overdue HR document or task using a given scenario.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Pair exchange and feedback using a politeness checklist.

Teacher Tip: Encourage B2 learners to combine two or more softening strategies in a single message for a more natural tone.

Session 8: Reporting & Summarizing Information in Writing

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
-------------	----------	--------	--------

B1–B2	90 minutes	Writing, Reading	Module 2
-------	------------	------------------	----------

Language Focus: Report structure — introduction, findings, recommendations; summarizing and paraphrasing language.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the structure and purpose of a short workplace report.
- Apply paraphrasing strategies to summarize information accurately.
- Produce a concise written summary or short report from given data.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can summarize a short text or dataset accurately and concisely.
- Can structure a short report with clear sections and headings.
- Can paraphrase source material without copying the original wording.

Materials

Sample short report • Raw data/notes for summarizing • Paraphrasing worksheet

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Identify the sections of a sample short report.
Input	20 min	Present report structure and paraphrasing techniques — synonym substitution, structure change.
Guided Practice	25 min	Paraphrasing drills; outline a report structure from given notes.
Production	25 min	Employees write a short report of 250 to 300 words summarizing a set of HR data or notes provided.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Self-check against a structure/clarity checklist; teacher spot-checks for paraphrasing accuracy.

Teacher Tip: Provide B1 learners with a report template or skeleton; B2 learners should design their own structure based on the content.

Session 9: Internal Memos, Announcements & Notices

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Writing	Module 2

Language Focus: Concise, impersonal style; passive voice for announcements; bullet-point formatting conventions.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the conventions of internal memos and workplace announcements.
- Apply passive voice appropriately for impersonal, official announcements.
- Produce a clear internal memo or notice for a workplace scenario.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can write a concise memo or announcement using appropriate formatting and tone.
- Can use passive voice correctly for impersonal announcements.
- Can distinguish when active vs. passive voice is more appropriate.

Materials

Sample memos/notices • Active/passive transformation worksheet • Scenario cards — policy change, office move, holiday schedule

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Compare an active-voice and a passive-voice version of the same announcement; discuss tone.
Input	20 min	Present memo conventions and passive-voice formation for announcements.
Guided Practice	25 min	Active-to-passive transformation drill; memo-structure matching exercise.
Production	25 min	Employees draft a memo announcing a workplace change based on a scenario card.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Gallery review of memos; class identifies the clearest example and why.

Teacher Tip: Real, anonymized memos from the learners' own organization, used with permission, make this session highly transferable.

Session 10: Writing Clear HR Policies & Procedures

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Writing, Reading	Module 2

Language Focus: Sequencing language; imperative and passive forms for instructions; clarity and conciseness strategies.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify features of clear, unambiguous policy and procedure writing.
- Apply sequencing language and appropriate grammatical forms to write step-based instructions.

- Produce a short, clear HR policy or procedure document.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can write clear, sequenced instructions for a workplace procedure.
- Can identify and revise ambiguous or unclear policy language.
- Can choose between imperative and passive forms appropriately for instructional writing.

Materials

Sample policy excerpts, clear and unclear • Sequencing-language reference sheet • Procedure-writing template • Module 2 review quiz

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Identify ambiguity in a poorly written policy excerpt.
Input	20 min	Present sequencing language and instructional grammar — imperative vs. passive.
Guided Practice	25 min	Rewrite an unclear policy excerpt for clarity; sequencing-language gap-fill.
Production	25 min	In pairs, employees write a short HR procedure, such as requesting leave or reporting an incident.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer review using a clarity checklist; Module 2 written review quiz covering email, memo, report, and policy.

Teacher Tip: *Emphasize that clarity, not complexity, is the mark of strong policy writing — a useful reframe for B2 learners who tend to over-elaborate.*

Module 3: Meetings & Collaboration

Builds the spoken and written language needed to schedule, participate in, lead, and document meetings, and to collaborate on group problem-solving.

Session 11: Scheduling Meetings & Setting Agendas

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Writing, Speaking	Module 3

Language Focus: Language for proposing and confirming times; agenda structure and vocabulary.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the components of an effective meeting agenda.
- Apply scheduling language to propose, confirm, and reschedule meetings.
- Produce a clear written meeting agenda for a given purpose.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can propose, confirm, or reschedule a meeting politely in writing or speech.
- Can draft a structured agenda with clear time allocations.
- Can read and interpret a colleague's agenda accurately.

Materials

Sample agendas • Scheduling-language phrase bank • Scenario cards for scheduling conflicts

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Compare a vague meeting invite with a clear one; identify the missing information.
Input	20 min	Present scheduling phrases and agenda-structure conventions.
Guided Practice	25 min	Role-play scheduling exchanges with conflicting calendars; agenda gap-fill exercise.
Production	25 min	Employees draft an agenda for an upcoming, real or simulated, team meeting.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Pair feedback on agenda clarity using a checklist.

Teacher Tip: B2 learners can be given a scheduling conflict requiring negotiation; B1 learners can work with a straightforward availability match.

Session 12: Participating in Meetings: Opinions, Agreement & Disagreement

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 3

Language Focus: Functional language for opinions, agreeing, disagreeing, and interrupting politely.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify functional phrases for expressing opinions and agreement or disagreement.
- Apply polite interruption and turn-taking strategies in discussion.
- Participate actively in a simulated meeting discussion.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can express an opinion and respond to others' opinions appropriately.
- Can disagree diplomatically without causing offense.
- Can interrupt and take turns politely in a group discussion.

Materials

Functional-language phrase cards • Discussion topic cards — workplace dilemmas • Audio model meeting extract

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Listen to a meeting extract and identify the agreement/disagreement phrases used.
Input	20 min	Present functional language for opinions, agreement, disagreement, and interruption.
Guided Practice	25 min	Controlled practice using phrase cards in pairs on a given topic.
Production	25 min	Small-group simulated meeting discussing a workplace dilemma, such as a new dress code policy.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Self-assessment on phrases used; teacher gives group feedback on diplomacy and turn-taking.

Teacher Tip: Assign a rotating “language observer” role so learners practice noticing functional language, not just producing it.

Session 13: Leading a Meeting: Facilitation Language

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
-------------	----------	--------	--------

B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking	Module 3
-------------------	------------	----------	----------

Language Focus: Facilitation phrases for opening, redirecting, summarizing, and closing a meeting.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the functional language used to open, manage, and close a meeting.
- Apply redirecting and summarizing language to keep a meeting on track.
- Lead a short simulated meeting using appropriate facilitation language.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can open and close a meeting using appropriate professional language.
- Can redirect a discussion that has gone off-topic.
- Can summarize key points and next steps at the end of a meeting.

Materials

Facilitation-language phrase bank • Meeting-roles cards • Timer for simulated meetings

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Brainstorm what makes a meeting feel well-run vs. chaotic.
Input	20 min	Present facilitation language for opening, redirecting, and closing.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice redirecting and summarizing language using prompt scenarios, such as a participant going off-topic.
Production	25 min	Rotating roles — each employee leads a five-minute segment of a simulated meeting.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer feedback using a facilitation checklist — opening, control, summary, closing.

Teacher Tip: Give B1 learners a facilitation script with gaps to personalize; B2 learners should facilitate without a script, using only the phrase bank as backup.

Session 14: Taking & Writing Minutes

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Writing, Listening	Module 3

Language Focus: Reported speech for minutes; minutes structure and conventions — action points, decisions.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the structure and purpose of meeting minutes.
- Apply reported speech accurately to summarize spoken discussion in writing.
- Produce a clear set of minutes from a simulated or recorded meeting.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can take notes during a meeting and convert them into structured minutes.
- Can use reported speech accurately to summarize what was said.
- Can identify and record action points and decisions clearly.

Materials

Sample minutes document • Reported-speech worksheet • Recorded short meeting or live simulated meeting from Session 13

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Compare direct quotes to their reported-speech equivalents.
Input	20 min	Present minutes structure and reported-speech grammar.
Guided Practice	25 min	Reported-speech transformation drill; identify action points in a sample transcript.
Production	25 min	Employees listen to, or recall from Session 13, a short meeting and write up the minutes.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer-check minutes against a completeness checklist — decisions, action points, owners, deadlines.

Teacher Tip: If possible, record the Session 13 simulated meetings to use as authentic source material here, reinforcing continuity across sessions.

Session 15: Collaborative Problem-Solving & Brainstorming

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 3

Language Focus: Brainstorming and idea-generation language; language for building on others' ideas; consensus-building phrases.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify language used to generate, build on, and prioritize ideas in a group.
- Apply consensus-building language to reach a group decision.
- Collaborate effectively in a problem-solving discussion in English.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can contribute and build on ideas during a brainstorming session.
- Can use language to prioritize and narrow down options as a group.
- Can reach and articulate a group consensus or decision.

Materials

Brainstorming-language phrase cards • Workplace problem-scenario cards • Flip-chart paper or whiteboard

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Rapid-fire idea generation on a light topic to model brainstorming flow.
Input	20 min	Present idea-generation, building-on, and consensus language.
Guided Practice	25 min	Controlled practice building on a partner's idea using target phrases.
Production	25 min	Small groups brainstorm solutions to a real or simulated HR challenge, then agree on a top recommendation.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Groups present their recommendation; oral mini-review of Module 3 functional language.

Teacher Tip: Choose a problem scenario genuinely relevant to the learners' workplace to increase engagement and transfer.

Module 4: HR-Specific Communication

Targets the specialized communication tasks central to HR practice: recruitment writing, interviewing, onboarding, performance feedback, and sensitive conversations.

Session 16: Recruitment Language: Job Descriptions & Job Ads

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Writing, Reading	Module 4

Language Focus: Job-ad vocabulary and conventions; modal verbs for requirements — must, should, would be an advantage.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the conventions and structure of job descriptions and job advertisements.
- Apply modal verbs to distinguish essential from desirable requirements.
- Produce a clear, well-structured job advertisement.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can write a job description with clearly distinguished essential and desirable criteria.
- Can use appropriate modal verbs and vocabulary in recruitment writing.
- Can identify unclear or biased language in a sample job ad and revise it.

Materials

Sample job ads, strong and weak • Modal-verb worksheet • Job-ad template

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Compare a vague job ad with a clear one; identify the differences.
Input	20 min	Present job-ad structure, vocabulary, and modal verbs for requirements.
Guided Practice	25 min	Sort criteria into essential/desirable using modals; revise a weak sample job ad.
Production	25 min	Employees write a job description or ad for a real or simulated open role.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer review focused on clarity and inclusive language.

Teacher Tip: Briefly flag language that can unintentionally signal bias, such as gendered terms, as part of the clarity discussion, since this is directly relevant to HR practice.

Session 17: Conducting Interviews: Questioning Techniques

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 4

Language Focus: Open vs. closed questions; behavioral/competency-based question structures, e.g. “Tell me about a time when...”.

Lesson Objectives

- Distinguish open, closed, and behavioral interview questions.
- Apply behavioral questioning structures to probe for specific examples.
- Conduct a short simulated interview using a structured question set.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can ask open, closed, and behavioral questions appropriately in an interview.
- Can follow up on a candidate’s answer with a relevant probing question.
- Can conduct a structured interview segment professionally.

Materials

Interview-question bank • Candidate role-play cards • Interview-evaluation form

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Sort sample questions into open, closed, and behavioral categories.
Input	20 min	Present question types and behavioral interviewing technique — situation, task, action, result.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice converting closed questions into open or behavioral ones.
Production	25 min	Paired role-play — interviewer and candidate conduct a ten-minute simulated interview, then swap roles.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Self/peer evaluation using an interview-skills checklist.

Teacher Tip: For B1 learners, provide a fixed set of behavioral question stems; B2 learners should generate original follow-up questions in real time.

Session 18: Onboarding New Employees: Explaining Procedures

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 4

Language Focus: Explaining and instructing language; sequencing connectors — first, next, once you’ve, make sure to.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify language for clearly explaining step-based procedures aloud.
- Apply sequencing connectors to structure spoken instructions logically.
- Deliver a short spoken explanation of an onboarding procedure.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can explain a multi-step procedure clearly and in logical order.
- Can check a listener’s understanding and clarify when needed.
- Can use sequencing connectors accurately in spoken explanations.

Materials

Sample onboarding checklist • Sequencing-connector phrase bank • New-employee role cards

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Listen to a poorly sequenced explanation and identify the confusion it causes.
Input	20 min	Present sequencing connectors and comprehension-checking language, such as “Does that make sense?”.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice sequencing a scrambled set of onboarding steps, then explain them aloud to a partner.
Production	25 min	Role-play — one employee explains an onboarding procedure to a “new hire” partner who asks clarifying questions.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Partner feedback on clarity and sequencing using a simple checklist.

Teacher Tip: Use the learners’ actual onboarding process as content where possible, since HR staff will use this language on the job almost immediately.

Session 19: Giving Constructive Performance Feedback

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 4

Language Focus: Feedback language — positive framing, “I” statements, Situation–Behavior–Impact structure; softening criticism.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the components of constructive, well-structured feedback.
- Apply softening and framing language to deliver feedback diplomatically.
- Deliver constructive feedback in a simulated performance conversation.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can give feedback using a clear, balanced structure of situation, behavior, and impact.
- Can soften critical feedback without losing clarity or honesty.
- Can respond professionally to feedback received.

Materials

Feedback-language phrase bank • Situation–Behavior–Impact handout • Performance-scenario role cards

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Compare blunt vs. constructive versions of the same feedback; discuss the impact.
Input	20 min	Present the Situation–Behavior–Impact structure and softening/framing language for feedback.
Guided Practice	25 min	Rewrite blunt feedback statements using the structure and softening language.
Production	25 min	Role-play simulated performance conversations between manager and employee, giving and receiving feedback.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer feedback on diplomacy and clarity using a structured checklist.

Teacher Tip: This session often surfaces strong opinions about management style — keep the focus on the language itself rather than HR policy debates, redirecting as needed.

Session 20: Handling Employee Grievances & Sensitive Conversations

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 4

Language Focus: Empathetic and neutral language; de-escalation phrases; confidentiality and procedural language.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify language strategies for staying neutral and empathetic in sensitive conversations.

- Apply de-escalation phrases to manage a tense exchange.
- Conduct a short, professional simulated grievance conversation.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can use neutral, empathetic language when handling a sensitive workplace issue.
- Can de-escalate a tense conversation using appropriate phrases.
- Can explain confidentiality and next steps clearly to an employee.

Materials

De-escalation phrase bank • Grievance-scenario role cards • Confidentiality-language handout • Module 4 review quiz

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Discuss what makes a sensitive conversation feel safe vs. unsafe for the employee involved.
Input	20 min	Present empathetic/neutral language, de-escalation phrases, and confidentiality language.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice rephrasing reactive statements into neutral, de-escalating ones.
Production	25 min	Role-play a short grievance conversation using a scenario card; swap roles.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Reflective discussion; Module 4 review quiz covering Sessions 16 through 20.

Teacher Tip: Set clear ground rules before role-play — no real names or live workplace cases — to keep the practice safe and professional.

Module 5: Presentations & Public Speaking

Develops the skills needed to plan, structure, and deliver a professional presentation, including describing data, handling questions, and delivering short training sessions.

Session 21: Structuring a Business Presentation

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking, Writing	Module 5

Language Focus: Presentation structure — introduction, body, conclusion; purpose and audience-analysis vocabulary.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the components of a well-structured business presentation.
- Apply audience-analysis principles to plan presentation content.
- Produce a structured outline for a short presentation.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can plan a presentation with a clear introduction, body, and conclusion.
- Can identify audience needs and adapt content accordingly.
- Can write a concise presentation outline.

Materials

Sample presentation outlines • Audience-analysis worksheet • Outline template

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Discuss the best and worst presentations learners have seen, and why.
Input	20 min	Present the three-part presentation structure and audience-analysis questions.
Guided Practice	25 min	Analyze a sample outline for structure; practice writing a purpose statement.
Production	25 min	Employees draft an outline for a presentation to be delivered in Sessions 24–25, on a topic of their choice or an assigned HR topic.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer feedback on outline clarity and structure.

Teacher Tip: Let learners choose a presentation topic connected to their actual role so later sessions build toward a genuinely usable deliverable.

Session 22: Presentation Language: Signposting & Transitions

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking	Module 5

Language Focus: Signposting phrases — firstly, moving on to, to summarize; transition language between sections.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify signposting language used to guide an audience through a presentation.
- Apply transition phrases to move clearly between presentation sections.
- Deliver a short presentation segment using signposting language accurately.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can use signposting language to structure a spoken presentation.
- Can transition smoothly between sections of a talk.
- Can signal the beginning, development, and end of a presentation clearly.

Materials

Signposting-phrase bank • Presentation outlines from Session 21 • Recorded model presentation extract

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Listen to a presentation extract and identify the signposting phrases used.
Input	20 min	Present a categorized signposting-language bank — introducing, sequencing, summarizing, concluding.
Guided Practice	25 min	Insert appropriate signposting phrases into a gapped presentation script.
Production	25 min	Using their Session 21 outline, employees rehearse and deliver the opening and one body section aloud to a partner.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Partner feedback on signposting use; self-correction notes.

Teacher Tip: Record short snippets, with consent, so learners can hear their own signposting use and self-correct.

Session 23: Describing Data: Charts, Graphs & Trends

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
-------------	----------	--------	--------

B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking, Writing	Module 5
-------------------	------------	-------------------	----------

Language Focus: Trend vocabulary — rise, fall, fluctuate, plateau; prepositions and adverbs for describing change.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify vocabulary for describing trends and data in charts and graphs.
- Apply appropriate adverbs and prepositions to describe the rate and direction of change.
- Produce an accurate spoken or written description of a data visual.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can describe trends shown in a chart or graph accurately.
- Can use trend vocabulary and adverbs of degree correctly.
- Can interpret HR data, such as turnover or engagement scores, and summarize key trends in English.

Materials

Sample charts/graphs, ideally HR data such as attrition or engagement • Trend-vocabulary handout • Data-description worksheet

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Look at a simple chart and brainstorm describing words.
Input	20 min	Present trend vocabulary and adverbs/prepositions for rate and direction of change.
Guided Practice	25 min	Sentence-building drills describing sample charts; error-correction exercise.
Production	25 min	Employees describe an HR-related chart or graph, real or provided, in a short spoken or written summary.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Pair-check accuracy of trend descriptions against the data shown.

Teacher Tip: Using genuine, anonymized HR metrics from the learners' organization makes this session immediately applicable to their reporting tasks.

Session 24: Handling Q&A & Engaging an Audience

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 5

Language Focus: Language for inviting, clarifying, and responding to questions; buying-time phrases.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify language for inviting and managing audience questions.
- Apply buying-time and clarification strategies when faced with a difficult question.
- Deliver and field questions on a short presentation segment confidently.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can invite and respond to audience questions appropriately.
- Can use buying-time language to handle an unexpected or difficult question.
- Can engage an audience using rhetorical questions and direct address.

Materials

Q&A phrase bank • Presentation outlines from Sessions 21–22 • Peer-feedback form

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Brainstorm what makes Q&A sessions feel awkward vs. confident.
Input	20 min	Present Q&A management language and buying-time strategies.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice responding to challenging sample questions using buying-time phrases.
Production	25 min	Employees deliver a three- to four-minute segment of their presentation to the group, followed by a live Q&A.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Structured peer feedback using a Q&A-skills checklist.

Teacher Tip: Encourage the audience to ask at least one genuinely challenging question to build confidence under realistic pressure.

Session 25: Delivering Training Sessions (Instructional Language)

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2 (B1 supported)	90 minutes	Speaking	Module 5

Language Focus: Instructional language for training delivery; checking understanding and managing group activities aloud.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify language used to instruct and manage a group during a training session.
- Apply comprehension-checking and instruction-giving language clearly.
- Deliver a short micro-training segment to colleagues.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can give clear spoken instructions for a group activity.
- Can check and confirm group understanding before moving on.
- Can manage timing and transitions when delivering training content.

Materials

Instructional-language phrase bank • Micro-training planning template • Module 5 review quiz/checklist

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Identify the difference between a clear instruction and a confusing one in a short audio clip.
Input	20 min	Present instruction-giving and comprehension-checking language for training contexts.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice giving instructions for a simple task to a partner without demonstrating, using only words.
Production	25 min	Employees deliver a five-minute micro-training on a simple HR-related topic to a small group.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer feedback; Module 5 review covering presentation structure, signposting, data description, and Q&A.

Teacher Tip: This session works well as a synthesis point — encourage learners to combine signposting, data description, and Q&A skills from earlier sessions in their micro-training.

Module 6: Negotiation, Persuasion & Intercultural Competence

Consolidates the course through negotiation, persuasive communication, conflict mediation, cross-cultural awareness, and an integrated final assessment scenario.

Session 26: Negotiation Basics: Language of Compromise

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2	90 minutes	Speaking	Module 6

Language Focus: Conditional sentences for negotiation; language of offering, countering, and compromising.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify the structure and functional language of a basic negotiation.
- Apply conditional sentences to make and respond to offers.
- Conduct a short simulated negotiation reaching a compromise.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can make, counter, and accept or reject an offer using appropriate language.
- Can use conditional sentences accurately in a negotiation context.
- Can reach and articulate a compromise position.

Materials

Negotiation phrase bank • Conditional-sentence worksheet • Negotiation role-play cards — budget, schedule, resource allocation

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Discuss a recent everyday negotiation, such as buying something, and the language used.
Input	20 min	Present negotiation functional language and conditional structures.
Guided Practice	25 min	Sentence-building drills with conditionals for offers and conditions.
Production	25 min	Paired negotiation role-play using scenario cards with conflicting goals.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Pairs report their outcome; class discusses which language strategies were most effective.

Teacher Tip: Give each side in the role-play private information the other doesn't have, to create authentic negotiation tension.

Session 27: Persuasive Language & Making a Business Case

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2	90 minutes	Speaking, Writing	Module 6

Language Focus: Persuasive language — benefits-focused phrasing, rhetorical questions, evidence framing; structuring an argument.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify persuasive language techniques used in business contexts.
- Apply benefits-focused framing to support a recommendation.
- Produce a short persuasive pitch or written business case.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can structure a persuasive argument with clear supporting points.
- Can use persuasive language to frame benefits and address objections.
- Can deliver or write a concise business case for a proposal.

Materials

Sample persuasive pitch, text or video • Persuasive-language phrase bank • Business-case template

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Identify persuasive techniques in a short sample pitch.
Input	20 min	Present persuasive language and a simple argument structure — claim, reason, evidence, benefit.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice reframing a feature as a benefit; build short arguments using the structure.
Production	25 min	Employees prepare and deliver a two-minute pitch for an HR initiative, such as a new training program or wellness policy.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Peer voting/feedback on the most persuasive pitch and why.

Teacher Tip: Encourage learners to anticipate and address one objection in their pitch — often the most challenging and valuable skill for B2 learners to develop.

Session 28: Conflict Resolution & Mediation Language

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B2	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 6

Language Focus: Mediation and neutral-reframing language; language for finding common ground.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify language strategies used to mediate a workplace conflict.
- Apply neutral reframing to de-personalize a disagreement.
- Mediate a short simulated workplace conflict between two parties.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can reframe a personal complaint into a neutral, solvable issue.
- Can use mediation language to guide two parties toward common ground.
- Can summarize a resolution or next steps clearly.

Materials

Mediation-language phrase bank • Conflict-scenario role cards — two disputants, one mediator
• Reframing worksheet

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Compare a personal accusation with its neutral reframe; discuss the impact on the listener.
Input	20 min	Present reframing and mediation language, including common-ground and summarizing phrases.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice reframing accusatory statements into neutral ones.
Production	25 min	Groups of three role-play a mediation — two disputants and one HR mediator — rotating roles.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Reflective discussion on which mediation strategies worked best.

Teacher Tip: Debrief explicitly on the difference between the language skill being practiced and real HR mediation protocol, to avoid conflating the two.

Session 29: Cross-Cultural Communication in the Workplace

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening	Module 6

Language Focus: Hedging and diplomatic language; vocabulary for discussing cultural difference respectfully; clarifying-meaning strategies.

Lesson Objectives

- Identify communication style differences that can arise in multicultural teams.
- Apply hedging and diplomatic language to navigate cross-cultural misunderstanding.
- Discuss a cross-cultural workplace scenario respectfully and constructively.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can discuss cultural communication differences respectfully and without stereotyping.
- Can use hedging language to soften potentially sensitive statements.
- Can clarify meaning when a cross-cultural misunderstanding arises.

Materials

Cross-cultural workplace scenario cards • Hedging-language phrase bank • Discussion-guideline handout

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Discuss a depersonalized example of cross-cultural miscommunication and what caused it.
Input	20 min	Present hedging/diplomatic language and guidelines for respectful discussion of cultural difference.
Guided Practice	25 min	Practice softening direct statements about cultural preferences using hedging language.
Production	25 min	Small groups discuss a cross-cultural workplace scenario and propose a respectful resolution.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Whole-group sharing; teacher reinforces ground rules for respectful, non-generalizing language.

Teacher Tip: Set explicit discussion norms beforehand, such as no broad generalizations about nationalities, to keep the conversation constructive and professional.

Session 30: Course Review, Mock Scenarios & Final Assessment

Level Focus	Duration	Skills	Module
B1–B2 (integrated review)	90 minutes	Speaking, Listening, Writing, Reading (integrated)	Module 6

Language Focus: Integrated review of course language across all modules; self-evaluation language.

Lesson Objectives

- Review and consolidate key language and skills covered across the course.

- Apply integrated business English skills in a multi-stage mock workplace scenario.
- Evaluate personal progress against course-level outcomes.

Lesson Outcomes

- Can perform an integrated, multi-skill business communication task under realistic conditions.
- Can self-evaluate progress against the course's learning outcomes.
- Can identify specific areas for continued language development after the course.

Materials

Mock-scenario pack combining email, meeting, and presentation elements • Final self-assessment form • Course outcomes checklist • Certificates of completion, if applicable

Teaching Procedure

Stage	Time	Description
Warm-up	10 min	Quick-fire review game covering functional language from across the course.
Input	20 min	Brief the mock scenario — a workplace situation requiring an email, a short meeting, and a two-minute update — and review expectations.
Guided Practice	25 min	Employees prepare their materials and notes for the mock scenario in pairs or small groups.
Production	25 min	Employees complete the integrated mock scenario, rotating through its stages of writing, meeting, and presenting.
Wrap-up & Assessment	10 min	Final self-assessment against course outcomes; teacher debrief and individual feedback plan; course closing.

Teacher Tip: Use this session's performance, alongside the cumulative formative record, as the primary evidence base for the final entries on the Course Assessment Checklist.

Part IV — Course Assessment Checklist

This checklist is designed for teachers to evaluate the success of the course at four points: before the course begins, at the end of each module, at course completion against course-level outcomes, and as a self-evaluation of instructional delivery. It is intended as a practical, working document — completed in real time by the teacher across the 30 sessions, and signed off at course end.

A. Pre-Course Readiness Checklist

- ☐ Needs analysis / placement assessment completed for all participants
- ☐ Participants' CEFR levels (B1/B2) confirmed and recorded
- ☐ Course materials and session resources prepared for Module 1
- ☐ Class roster, scheduling, and room/platform logistics confirmed
- ☐ Individual learning goals discussed and recorded (Session 1)

B. Module-by-Module Outcome Checklist

To be marked at the end of each module, based on observed performance in the module's production and wrap-up tasks.

Module 1: Foundations of Professional Communication

- ☐ Learners can deliver a structured professional self-introduction
- ☐ Learners can initiate and sustain basic workplace small talk
- ☐ Learners can manage a professional phone/video call
- ☐ Learners can ask for and give information using direct and indirect questions
- ☐ Learners can describe their role and organizational structure accurately

Module 2: Written Business Communication

- ☐ Learners can write a clearly structured, appropriately toned email
- ☐ Learners can make polite requests and follow-ups using modal verbs
- ☐ Learners can summarize information into a short written report
- ☐ Learners can write a clear internal memo or announcement
- ☐ Learners can write a clear HR policy or procedure document

Module 3: Meetings & Collaboration

- ☐ Learners can schedule meetings and draft a clear agenda
- ☐ Learners can participate in meetings, expressing opinions and (dis)agreement diplomatically
- ☐ Learners can facilitate or lead a short meeting segment
- ☐ Learners can take and write accurate meeting minutes
- ☐ Learners can contribute to collaborative problem-solving discussions

Module 4: HR-Specific Communication

- ☐ Learners can write a clear, inclusive job description or advertisement
- ☐ Learners can conduct a structured interview using open and behavioral questions
- ☐ Learners can explain an onboarding procedure clearly
- ☐ Learners can deliver constructive performance feedback
- ☐ Learners can handle a sensitive conversation or grievance professionally

Module 5: Presentations & Public Speaking

- ☐ Learners can structure and outline a business presentation
- ☐ Learners can use signposting language to guide an audience
- ☐ Learners can describe data trends accurately
- ☐ Learners can field audience questions confidently
- ☐ Learners can deliver a short training segment with clear instructions

Module 6: Negotiation, Persuasion & Intercultural Competence

- ☐ Learners can negotiate and reach a compromise using appropriate language
- ☐ Learners can deliver a persuasive pitch or business case
- ☐ Learners can use mediation language to address workplace conflict
- ☐ Learners can discuss cross-cultural communication respectfully
- ☐ Learners can complete an integrated, multi-skill mock workplace scenario

C. Course-Level Outcomes: Final Evaluation

To be completed at course end (Session 30), based on the integrated mock scenario and the cumulative formative record from Sections A and B.

Course-Level Outcome	Not Yet	Developing	Achieved
Can communicate confidently in routine professional interactions (B1) and in increasingly complex, nuanced exchanges (B2).	☐	☐	☐
Can write coherent, appropriately structured business correspondence and HR documentation.	☐	☐	☐
Can actively contribute to, and where required lead, meetings and group discussions in English.	☐	☐	☐
Can perform core HR communication tasks — interviewing, feedback, policy explanation — accurately and professionally.	☐	☐	☐
Can deliver a clear, organized presentation	☐	☐	☐

Course-Level Outcome	Not Yet	Developing	Achieved
and respond to questions from colleagues or stakeholders.			
Can negotiate solutions and manage workplace conflict using appropriate diplomatic language.	☐	☐	☐

D. Course Delivery & Instructional Quality Checklist

A self-evaluation for the teacher to complete at course end, reflecting on delivery quality rather than learner achievement.

- ☐ All 30 sessions were delivered within the planned timeframe
- ☐ Lesson objectives were communicated clearly at the start of each session
- ☐ Differentiation strategies (B1 scaffold / B2 extension) were applied consistently
- ☐ Formative assessment (peer/self-checks) was used in every session
- ☐ Materials were relevant and, where possible, contextualized to learners' real workplace
- ☐ Learner engagement and participation were consistently high
- ☐ Module review points (Sessions 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30) were used to check progress
- ☐ The final mock scenario (Session 30) reflected realistic workplace demands

E. Course Completion Summary

To be completed and signed by the teacher at the close of the course.

Cohort / Group Name:		
Organization:		
Course Start Date:	Course End Date:	
Number of Participants:	Number of Completers:	
Overall Course Success Rating:	Excellent / Good / Satisfactory / Needs Improvement	
Teacher / Trainer Name:	Signature:	Date:

Note: This checklist evaluates both learner achievement and course delivery. A course should be considered successful when the majority of course-level outcomes in Section C are rated "Achieved," and the instructional quality checklist in Section D is substantially complete.